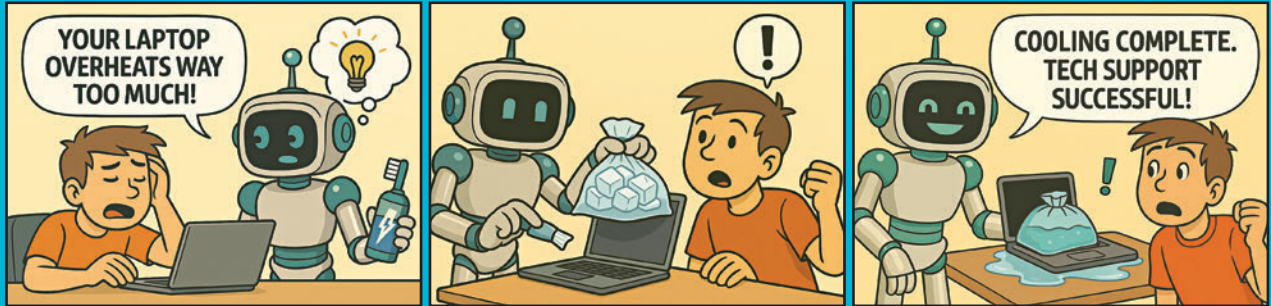


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How Zuckerberg, Musk and Altman see future of AI differently

Their vision of AI is dramatically different as can be

—By Jayesh Shinde

It's difficult not to draw these parallels, among the loudest voices trying to shape and dominate the world's AI destiny. It's clear with the latest moves related to Meta Superintelligence Lab, that Zuckerberg's playbook is neither Musk's open-source hardware crusade nor Altman's phased AGI safety dance.

In a corner is Mark Zuckerberg, champion of "personal superintelligence" and muscle of Meta's vast user universe. In another, Elon Musk, an evangelist for open-source liberation and distributed innovators of tomorrow. And casting a measured, safety-first glance at both is Sam Altman, the pragmatist building AI through strategic alliance and phased public rollouts.

Mark Zuckerberg's fortress of superintelligence

On June 30, 2025, Zuckerberg staked Meta's claim for "personal superintelligence" by merging FAIR, Llama development, and a fresh next-gen

models team under Alexandr Wang and Nat Friedman. The internal memo that day read almost like a manifesto to build an AI so bound to each user's digital life that it felt as natural as breathing.

This isn't a vanity project for Zuckerberg. Because Meta has pledged \$14.3 billion to secure a near-half stake in Wang's startup and bankroll the



acquisition spree known as PlayAI. The mission seems to be to fold AI into every chat, every AR shimmer – from News Feed assistants that summarize your weekend, to smart glasses that whisper context into your ear in real time.

Sam Altman's balanced AI optimism

In this AI arena, if Zuckerberg is the

industrial planner and Musk the anarchist, Altman is the tightrope walker. Under Altman, OpenAI's bedrock partnership with Microsoft has swelled to \$13 billion in Azure compute and co-development commitments. But Altman isn't content to lurch from GPT-4 to GPT-5 in a single bound. Instead, he champions "phased public rollouts," propelling GPT-4.1 and GPT-4.2 into the wild to harvest real-world usage data and burrow in safety guardrails.

Last May, he had testified before the U.S. Senate, urging lawmakers to avoid knee-jerk regulation that might cede American AI leadership to overseas rivals. At the same time, OpenAI's "Preparedness Framework" now boasts formal system cards and a safety committee empowered to impose launch-blocking checks when necessary.

The goal is clear: move quickly enough to innovate, but also leave room for reflection – and the occasional course correction – before unleashing a model that could inadvertently turbocharge disinformation or automate the next wave of cyberattacks.

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